EXT. AURVANGAR FIELDS - DAY

An endless stretch of tall grass sways beneath a pale sky.
Wind rolls across the field in slow, uneven waves.
A lone figure is sat in the grass, leaning against a lone tree, hugging her knees together.
KARSI (19-20 y/o), stares down at the ground before her.
Dark, dried blood stains the soil.
She hasn't touched it.
Hasn't moved.

KARSI (V.O.)
They say grass is a sign of life...

KARSI (V.O.)
...is that why they call it irony? Because of how hard and cold it is when it hits you?

KARSI (V.O.)
I'm being hunted. We both were, but never like this. Not quite 'empire's most-wanted' status, but it sure as hell feels that way.

KARSI (V.O.)
They're closing in on me, and there's only so many corners I can cut before I run myself into a dead end.
Yet, I still find time to come back here.

KARSI (V.O.)
I used to visit more frequently, nearer to when it happened... every time it was somewhat safe to.
I was always hoping you'd be here waiting for me.
But it was just your blood, getting blacker and more coagulated as time passed.

KARSI (V.O.)
Over days.
Then weeks.
Then months, and...

KARSI (V.O.)
God.

Has it really been a year already?

KARSI (V.O.)
It's almost like time jogs next to me while I'm on the run.
Is that Lady Fate, or whatever sadist higher powers exist out there... showing me sympathy?
By speeding it up so I grow old and die sooner, knowing I'm too stubborn to roll over instead?

KARSI (V.O.)
What am I doing?
I'm trying to do something honorable, for once.
I'm trying to pay my respects to you, but I'm multitasking.
I can't stop fighting myself.
I can't kick this stupid game of 'What if?' that kicked off when you left me...

KARSI (V.O.)
You left me.
I'm trying to pay my respects... but you left me.
Here.
Alone, Farron.

KARSI (V.O.)
I'm trying to pay you something- anything, but the truth is...
I resent you.
...and this grassy deathbed of yours.

A young voice cuts through the air and breaks Karsi's trance. It's HOPE, speaking through her commlink.

HOPE (O.S.)
Karsi, you there?

Karsi freezes.
Her hand moves instantly to the commlink device on her ear.
She's alert, soldier mode returning.

KARSI
Yeah.
I'm here.

- SCENE II: THE HELL WHERE WE WORK (END)

INT. GIBRALTAR’S OFFICE – NIGHT

RED leans against a wall behind a heavy desk to the left of the door, breathing hard, hand over his deep WOUND.

Outside, a ROYAL GUNSHIP roars past the building. Its searchlight sweeps across the nearby streets, spilling light through the windows before drifting away.

Red exhales slightly in relief. He wipes sweat from his forehead.

FOOTSTEPS approach in the hallway.

GIBRALTAR (O.S.)
Your grace, with all due respect, what do you mean he’s in my sector? Isn’t he supposed to be in solita—

GIBRALTAR opens his office door. He enters, still speaking into his commlink.

GIBRALTAR
Oh… oh my. Yes, of course, sir. I understand. I—

He freezes as the cold barrel of a PISTOL presses into his back.

Red emerges from the shadows, his eyes burning into Gibraltar's head from behind.

Gibraltar swallows.

GIBRALTAR
…will be in touch.
Thank you, your grace.

He ends the call.

Red immediately snatches the commlink from his hand and hurls it across the room.

CRASH.

The device smashes through the office window. Glass rains down onto the

floor.

RED
Sit down.

He gestures toward the chair with the pistol.

Gibraltar hesitates.

Red steps forward and shoves the barrel into Gibraltar’s mouth.

RED
SIT.

Gibraltar slowly lowers himself into the chair.

Red begins pacing, his grip tightening around the weapon.

RED
You… you had one job. Stay quiet, do your work, and live a lavish life filled with my gifts when you came home from a long, hard day of doing absolutely FUCKING nothing.

Suddenly—

BANG. BANG.

Red fires two shots into the wall behind Gibraltar in a fit of rage.
Dust and plaster explode outward.

RED
But instead… you made everything difficult for everyone involved.
Even you.

Red drags a hand down his face.

RED
Why.

Silence.

Gibraltar swallows hard.

GIBRALTAR
For her.

Red blinks.

RED
What?

GIBRALTAR
...Karsi.
For her.

SIRENS begin to wail in the distance. Faint at first. Getting closer.

GIBRALTAR
Even down in the hell where we work, having a heart earns you favors in places you can't see, Davon.
She has one, unlike you. It’s why I couldn’t have her there when I brought down hell on you and your empire.
I couldn’t kill her, not for your sins.

RED
You...?

Red wheezes and laughs out loud, doubling over as Gibraltar shifts uncomfortably in his seat.

RED
YOU, want to lecture ME about having a heart? Right! And just how many people did you consign to unknown fates just to get yourself to stand out to me?

GIBRALTAR
Then consider this an atonement.

RED
Even God Himself wouldn't stoop down to wash you clean. You signed away all hope to see the pearly gates when you set your sights on the picture I've been painting. And now you expect me to buy that just ONE person was all it too—

Red freezes, realization washes over his face. It is almost as if time itself has stopped for just a moment. The SIRENS in the distance fade completely, The dust

and plaster stop spreading across the room.

It's just them.

RED
Ah, that's right.

Gibraltar tenses slightly at the sudden, eerie calmness Red displays.

GIBRALTAR
I—

RED
You love her, don’t you?

Gibraltar hesitates, shifting a little bit more, before he musters up the confidence to speak again.

GIBRALTAR
...yes, I do.

Silence.

Then—

Red starts to laugh.

Slow at first. Then louder.

RED
Isn't that rich?
Now neither of us get her.

Gibraltar opens his mouth—

BANG. BANG. BANG. BANG. BANG.

Red unloads the PISTOL into the chair.

Smoke and RED MIST fills the room.

CLICK.

The PISTOL is empty.

Red lets the weapon fall to the floor, eyes still staring on intensely at Gibraltar's body.

His laughter ceases, and he walks slowly toward the shattered window.

EXT. CITY STREETS – CONTINUOUS

Enforcers flood the streets below. Gunships circle overhead. Searchlights sweep across rooftops.

INT. GIBRALTAR’S OFFICE – CONTINUOUS

A powerful SEARCHLIGHT suddenly pierces the room, illuminating Red in stark white.

He doesn’t move.

Then—

A ROCKET streaks toward the building.

SMASH.

The missile tears through the window.

WHITE FLASH.